

Let us look at the difference between the ActionScript 2 and the ActionScript 3 in details:

By using Flash CS3, Flash 8 and Flash MX 2004 we can publish the ActionScript 2 files but we can only publish the files of ActionScript 3 by using the Flash CS3.

ActionScript 2 is the foundation for Flash Lite 2 and Flash Lite 3 that are used in mobile phones. The external .swf files that are coded with ActionScript 2 can be loaded by ActionScript 3.swf files.

The files of ActionScript 2 can be run in several versions of Flash player like Flash Player 7, Flash Player 8 and Flash Player 9. Files created with ActionScript 3 can only run in Flash Player 9—which is what most users face problems with.

Also, since most users find it easy to work with ActionScript 2, and only a few use ActionScript 3, we'll stick to 2 for this Fast Track. Plus, most people already have sites based on ActionScript 2, they're reluctant to upgrade. Though we must add that keeping yourself updated and future-proof means that once you have mastered ActionScript 2, you should learn 3, as it will not only help you with Flash, but also with Adobe Flex.

Like all other scripting languages, ActionScripting follows conventions, which means developers find it comfortable to work with, and designers also find it easy to handle codes.